



Activity 1.4: How did word processors change the world?

Use the internet to carry out research to answer the question: How did word processors change the world?

Use the mind map template to keep notes as you carry out your research. The template is designed to get you started and you may have to add or remove, or change the shape of text boxes as you work.

You are **ONLY** being asked to make notes,
NOT to produce a finished and complete summary of your research.

As a starting point, try to find out what the world was like and how documents were produced before the first commercial word-processor application was launched, and how things changed when the word processor became available and affordable for office and home use.

Remember the following key principles when carrying out research on the internet:

- Do not plagiarise! Never pretend you wrote words that were originally written by someone else.
- If you want to use someone else's words, quote them. Use quotation marks around the words you are copying and cite your source (give the name of the author and the URL or the website you copied the quote from).
- Do not use copy and paste unless you have read, understood and are quoting the text you are pasting.
- Assess the trustworthiness of each source. Look out for:
 - accuracy: Are there facts and figures to back up opinions?
 - currency: When was the article written? Has it been updated recently?
 - author: Is the author named? Are they qualified to comment on the subject they are writing about?
 - hosting website: Is the organisation hosting the website well known and generally considered to be trustworthy?
 - balanced presentation: Are both sides of an argument covered in equal measure?
 - professional tone: Is the article well written? It should avoid textspeak, street language and inappropriately emotional language.

